



S.K. Bhattacharya, MD, SBI receiving the award for the most preferred bank from Shavard Pawar



Kishore Biyani - CEO, Future Group receiving the award for the most preferred multi-brand food retail chain from Akshay Kumar



Mayank Pareek, Executive Officer, Maruti Suzuki receiving the award for the most preferred car brand from Praseon Joshi

19 per cent while Nirma came in third with 10 per cent.

FINANCIAL SERVICES

Trustworthiness of the company was the most important driver for all financial services. Also, government banks and companies tended to get more votes than others across zones. Among financial services, both SBI and ICICI walked away with two awards each while LIC was the most preferred life insurance company. In the case of loans, hassle-free processing and lower interest rates got more votes.

BANKS: Other than trustworthiness nearly 40 per cent of the respondents chose wide network of branches and ATMs as primary drivers. SBI, which has all of those going for it, was the preferred bank with 25 per cent of votes. ICICI Bank came a distant second with 9 per cent.

LIFE INSURANCE POLICIES: The verdict was almost unanimous - Life Insurance Corporation with 80 per cent votes, offering better returns and a variety of schemes and offers was the leader in life insurance companies in the country. Bajaj Allianz with just 2 per cent votes was a far second.

CREDIT CARDS: In addition to banks being trustworthy, what people voted most for was hassle free procedure and prompt response to customer queries. ICICI Bank with nearly fourth of the votes edged out both SBI (18 per cent) and HDFC (13 per cent).

HOME LOANS: SBI won the segment visibly with nearly 22 per cent votes. They came in for the bank's hassle free procedure, low interest and prompt approval of loans. ICICI Bank with 19 per cent of votes came in second while HDFC was third with 13 per cent.

AUTO LOANS: Like home loans, preference in auto loans was given to easy processing and low interest rates. ICICI was the preferred brand with 31 per cent votes. HDFC with 16 per cent and SBI with 13 per cent were a distant second and third.

RETAIL

The presence of many local players affected the ratings of the retail segment. Innovative formats across categories meant that the votes were split among a large number of brands. However, the key driver was distinct for each category - variety of products (50 per cent) and proximity (46 per cent) for food and grocery stores, hygiene (52 per cent) and ambience (59 per cent) for food and beverage chains and stylish designs (75 per cent) for jewellery. In the South zone and among older

respondents, ability to customise jewellery designs was an emerging driver.

MULTI-BRAND FOOD RETAIL: Big Bazaar was the most preferred multi-brand food store with nearly 34 per cent of votes. Apart from good value for money and good locations, it won the votes for good ambience and efficient staff. Reliance Fresh was a distant second with 18 per cent votes with Subhiksha and Food World trailing far behind.

FAST FOOD & BEVERAGE CHAIN: Consumers were partial to those that were not just hygienic, but also has good ambience and efficient staff. For a second time running, Café Coffee Day remained the most preferred chain across zones with 16 per cent of votes. McDonalds and Coffee House came in second with 11 per cent of votes while Barista was a close fourth with 10 per cent.

LIFESTYLE BRAND: Going beyond the family jeweller, Tanishq lead the segment with 31 per cent of votes. It was valued for both stylish designs

and quality assurance. Customised jewellery was an important driver particularly for the South zone. Both Asmi and Agni brands of jewellery came in a far second with just 6 per cent of votes.

AUTOMOBILES

Fuel-efficiency and mileage was the key driver for both cars and two-wheelers across all zones. However, respondents from the East zone also preferred cars that offered latest technology and good looks. Latest technology was also an important element with South zone voting for bikes.

CARS: The country's largest car manufacturer Maruti Suzuki remained the most preferred with more than 41 per cent of votes. The main drivers apart from mileage, was a sense of pride in ownership, look and appearance and latest features. Both Hyundai and Tata came in second with 12 per cent while Honda was

third with just 9 per cent.

TWO-WHEELERS: With key drivers like good looks, latest features and low-maintenance, Hero Honda received a 43 per cent of voters. Bajaj came in second with 31 per cent. Honda was a distant third with 9 per cent votes while TVS fell behind with just 8 per cent.

SPECIAL MENTION

In recognition to the outstanding contribution made in their respective fields, CNBC AWAAZ Consumer Awards'08 gave away special citations: 'Entertainment Brand Ambassador of the Year' to actor Akshay Kumar, 'Commendation For Transforming Cricket in India' to Lalit Modi and 'CNBC AWAAZ Hall of Fame' to BSNL at the awards ceremony.

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

The Nielsen study was conducted in 21 cities across 12 states. For the first time, 84 rural centers (4 around each city) with population of 3,000 or more were also included in the study. Following random sampling process, nearly 10000 interviews were conducted with men and women in 18-45 age groups, from SEC A, B and C households in the cities and SEC R1 and R2 in the rural centers. To ensure geographical coverage, a pre-decided number of starting point addresses were selected and a fixed number of interviews were conducted using the Right Hand Rule which eliminates interviewer bias in selecting the household.

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